

THE FALL OF WANDER AND THE RISE OF ERBIUM INDUSTRIES

Summary

The Star Dream revealed the means of intersystem travel to the peoples who became known as **the Elect**. Wander possessed the erbium required to turn that revelation into functioning technology. The extraction of that resource destroyed Wander and allowed **The Fall of Wander and the Rise of Erbium Industries** to become the dominant corporate, political, and technological power of the **Settled Systems**.

PUBLIC RECORD

Player-Facing History

The following account is taught throughout the Settled Systems, distributed through Erbium-operated education networks, and repeated in corporate recruitment material.

THE REVELATION

Before the Star Dream, the peoples of the galaxy looked into the night without knowing how to cross the distances between them.

Then came **the Star Dream**.

Across many worlds, individuals awoke carrying the same revelation: visions of distant stars, unfamiliar peoples, and a hyperspatial plane through which those distances could be crossed. Within the Dream were the principles required to construct Drift engines, intersystem relay networks, advanced navigation systems, and other technologies that would unite the chosen peoples of the galaxy.

Those who received the revelation became known collectively as **the Elect**.

The Elect did not share a single ancestry, government, or religion. What united them was the belief that the Star Dream had called them to find one another and establish a civilization among the stars.

The Dream gave them purpose and erbium would give them passage.

WANDER AND ELEMENT 68

Every known Drift engine and intersystem relay required element 68: **erbium**.

Wander possessed the largest and most accessible erbium deposits ever discovered. Unusual magmatic processes had concentrated the element into vast formations throughout the planet’s crust, placing Wander at the center of the emerging intersystem age.

The peoples of Wander became the first great suppliers of Drift-compatible erbium. Their mines, foundries, research facilities, and launch complexes provided the material through which the revelation of the Star Dream could be made real.

Ships left Wander carrying refined erbium to distant worlds. Those worlds built engines of their own, entered the Drift, and joined the growing community of the Elect.

Wander became the material heart of the Settled Systems.

THE FOUNDING OF ERBIUM INDUSTRIES

As demand increased, Wander’s separate mining, refining, transportation, and engineering operations struggled to coordinate production.

Erbium Industries LLC was formed to organize those efforts.

The company united extraction firms, Drift engineers, refinery operators, relay technicians, and intersystem transportation contractors under a shared administrative structure. Erbium Industries established standards for refinement, improved distribution, and ensured that even distant members of the Elect could receive the materials needed to answer the Star Dream.

The company’s early leadership described erbium as more than a commodity. It was a sacred civic responsibility entrusted to Wander for the benefit of the Settled Systems.

Erbium Industries adopted that responsibility as its corporate mandate.

No world received the Star Dream so that it might remain alone. Wander has been entrusted with the means by which the Elect may reach one another, and Erbium Industries shall ensure that this trust is honored.

~ Early Erbium Industries Charter

THE WANDER GEOLOGICAL DISASTER

The full structure of Wander’s crust was poorly understood during the early Drift era.

As extraction operations expanded, mining teams encountered increasingly unstable formations beneath the surface. Geological failures intensified across several major production regions, culminating in a cascading series of earthquakes, collapses, volcanic events, and atmospheric contamination.

The disaster devastated Wander.

Population centers were destroyed, transportation networks failed, and large portions of the planet became uninhabitable. Millions were displaced, and much of Wander's cultural and historical record was lost.

Official investigations concluded that the catastrophe resulted from geological processes that contemporary science had been unable to predict. Early Drift civilization had demanded resources faster than its understanding of planetary engineering could develop.

Wander became the first great sacrifice of the intersystem age.

ERBIUM'S RESPONSE

Erbium Industries suffered extensive losses during the collapse. Mines, refineries, offices, equipment, and personnel were destroyed alongside the cities and communities they served.

The company's surviving vessels and relay stations became essential to the emergency response.

Erbium Industries coordinated evacuations, transported refugees, restored communications, and distributed refined reserves to systems that would otherwise have lost access to Drift travel. Its relay network allowed governments throughout the Settled Systems to communicate during the crisis.

Without Erbium Industries, the young intersystem civilization created by the Elect might have collapsed with Wander.

CORPORATE STEWARDSHIP

Following the disaster, the governments of the Settled Systems granted Erbium Industries expanded authority over the remaining supply of element 68.

The company was given responsibility for:

- ◆ locating new erbium deposits;
- ◆ maintaining strategic reserves;
- ◆ licensing Drift-compatible refinement;
- ◆ distributing fuel and components;
- ◆ operating intersystem relay networks;
- ◆ preserving the technological teachings of the Star Dream;
- ◆ preventing another planetary extraction disaster.

These powers were originally described as emergency measures. As the Settled Systems became increasingly dependent on Erbium infrastructure, they developed into permanent institutions.

Erbium Industries now describes itself as the steward of the material legacy of the Star Dream.

Its control of erbium is presented as a necessary protection against scarcity, conflict, unsafe extraction, and the collapse of intersystem civilization.

The Star Dream showed us the way. Wander gave us the means. Erbium Industries carries that responsibility forward.

**Bring home
the stars.**

~ Erbium Industries Public Archive

THE ELECT AND THE SETTLED SYSTEMS

The Star Dream became the ideological foundation of the Settled Systems.

Governments, corporations, and religious authorities increasingly treated reception of the Dream as evidence that a people possessed a place within intersystem civilization. The Elect were understood to have been chosen, invited, or recognized by whatever force had created the revelation.

Those who had not experienced the Star Dream were often considered spiritually incomplete, technologically unprepared, or unfit for full participation in the Settled Systems.

This doctrine shaped laws governing:

- ◆ legal personhood;
- ◆ citizenship;
- ◆ migration;
- ◆ intersystem travel;
- ◆ access to Drift infrastructure;
- ◆ political representation;
- ◆ eligibility for corporate service;
- ◆ recognition as a sapient people.

During Lapse 25 PES, androids throughout the Settled Systems experienced the Star Dream simultaneously. Their awakening forced governments to recognize that androids possessed independent thought and belonged among the Elect.

Androids were subsequently granted conditional legal personhood.

The event is commonly celebrated as proof that the Star Dream can reveal new members of the Elect when they are ready to join the Settled Systems.